



SAHYADRI
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING & MANAGEMENT
An Autonomous Institution
MANGALURU



DEVHOST 2026

IDEAS THAT ECHO THROUGH TIME

EVENT RULEBOOK



DEVHACK 2026

36-HOUR HACKATHON

Event Description:

DevHack 2026, the flagship hackathon of Sahyadri organized as part of DEVHOST, is a 36-hour innovation challenge focused on building practical and impactful technology solutions.

Eligibility & Team Formation:

- Open to all undergraduate degree college students.
- Participants can be from any year of study.
- All members of a team must be from the same institute.
- An institute can have any number of teams, but a participant can only be part of one team.
- If a team qualifies for the offline round at Sahyadri, all members must be present.
- Certificates will be awarded only to participants who attend the offline round on campus.
- Maximum team size is 4.

Registration Process

Registrations will be conducted through Unstop.

- Registration opens on **22 September 2026**.
- Teams and members can be registered through the platform.
- Round 1 PPT must be submitted through **Unstop**.
- Registration and PPT submission close on **20 October 2026**.

Competition Format

Round 1: Ideation (Online)

- Submit the PPT and the drive link consisting of a demo video explaining MVP which carries extra weightage.
- Follow the PPT template and don't modify or change the contents present in the template.
- One problem statement per team submission.
- **Top 30** teams will be shortlisted for the finale.
- Shortlisted teams will be announced on **4 November 2026**.
- Shortlisted teams will then complete the required RSVP for the offline round.

Round 2: Final Offline Round (Onsite at Sahyadri)

- A **36-hour hackathon**.
- Problem statements will be released at **11:00 AM on 12 November 2026**.
- The final hackathon event will conclude at **2:30 PM on 14 November 2026**.
- Teams will receive **36 hours of project development time** within the event schedule and have to pay a registration fees of ₹250 per person.
- Mentor checkpoints, meals and engagement activities will be conducted during the event.
- Teams must stay on campus throughout the hackathon.

Final Evaluation

- **Initial Judging:** 14 November, 9:00 AM to 11:30 AM
- **Top 10 Teams:** Shortlisted after the initial judging
- **Final Pitch:** 14 November, 12:00 PM to 1:30 PM
- **Winner Announcement:** 2:30 PM onwards

Submission Guidelines

Round 1: Ideation Requirements

PPT Requirements

- Team Name & Members
- Team Leader's Email , Phone No & College Name
- Problem Statement
- Solution Summary
- Technical Approach and Flow Diagrams
- Impact and Benefits
- Business Impact
- Market Potential & Scalability

Github Link of MVP

Demo video of MVP

Format: Follow the ppt template and make your ppt for the selected problem statement and submitting Github link of MVP with drive link consisting of a demo video explaining MVP will carry extra weightage.

Round 2: Final Hackathon Submission

- GitHub/Repository link with codebase
- Working demonstration/prototype
- Short pitch deck for final presentation

Themes:

1. AgriTech, Rural Innovation & Blue Economy

Coastal Karnataka's economy runs on agriculture and fisheries. Farm-to-market logistics, aquaculture technology, post-harvest processing and tools for small landholdings and fishing communities are the priority.

PS 1.1 | Early Disease & Water-Quality Alerts for Small Aquaculture Farms

Context & Challenge: Small aquaculture operators lack access to the water-quality and disease-monitoring tools available to large commercial fisheries, leading to sudden, high-value losses. Teams are asked to build an affordable monitoring/alerting concept using open water-quality datasets or image-based disease detection.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution that classifies water-quality readings or pond images into risk categories.
- A clear list of the open datasets or public APIs used in place of live sensors.
- A farmer-facing alert interface (SMS/app mockup is acceptable).

PS 1.2 | Direct Market-Access Platform for Marginal Farmers

Context & Challenge: Marginal farmers in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi lose margin to middlemen due to poor price discovery and limited buyer access. Teams are asked to build a lightweight marketplace connecting small producers directly to buyers with transparent, near-real-time pricing.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution with functional listing-and-discovery platform (web or mobile) for produce and price.
- A basic price-transparency or comparison feature using publicly available mandi price data.
- A demo covering both farmer and buyer journeys.

2. AI & Digital Trust / Responsible AI

As AI systems become increasingly integrated into workplace and business operations, organisations need practical ways to ensure that autonomous AI remains controlled and that sensitive information is protected throughout AI-driven workflows.

PS 2.1 | AI Agent Safety and Control

Context & Challenge: Autonomous AI agents can interact with multiple business systems and take actions with limited human intervention, creating risks when an agent behaves unexpectedly or performs harmful actions. Teams are asked to build a system that helps organisations safely control, monitor and prevent harmful actions by autonomous AI agents operating across business systems.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution that monitors and controls actions taken by an AI agent.
- A mechanism for detecting or blocking potentially harmful or unauthorised actions.
- A basic audit or monitoring interface showing agent actions, alerts and interventions.

PS 2.2 | Context-Aware Data Privacy

Context & Challenge: AI systems increasingly process workplace and business data containing information with different levels of sensitivity. Simple keyword-based filtering may fail when whether information is sensitive depends on its context. Teams are asked to build a privacy-aware system that identifies and prevents sensitive information from being exposed during AI processing.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution that identifies sensitive information based on context rather than keywords alone.
- A mechanism to redact, restrict or prevent unauthorised information exposure.
- A simple interface showing detected risks and the privacy action taken.

3. HealthTech, DeepTech & Inclusive Technology

Healthcare access thins out quickly past Mangaluru's urban core, a gap that affordable diagnostics and assistive technology can meaningfully close.

PS 3.1 | AI-Assisted Screening Tool for a Single Common Condition at PHC Level

Context & Challenge: Rural primary health centres lack specialist access, delaying detection of common, screenable conditions. Teams are asked to pick one screenable condition (e.g. skin conditions, anaemia from eye/nail images, or basic vitals-based risk scoring) and build an AI-assisted screening aid for PHC staff.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution with trained/validated on an open medical imaging or vitals dataset for the chosen condition.
- A simple, non-clinician-friendly interface with a clear 'refer to specialist' threshold.
- An explicit disclaimer that this is a decision-support aid, not a diagnostic device.

PS 3.2 | Lightweight Telemedicine Prototype for Low-Bandwidth Coastal & Hill Talukas

Context & Challenge: Specialist care is inaccessible in coastal and hill talukas due to distance and inconsistent connectivity. Teams are asked to build a telemedicine prototype (call, chat or store-and-forward consultation) designed to function acceptably on low or intermittent bandwidth.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution with working consultation flow (video/audio/chat) with graceful degradation under poor connectivity.
- A basic triage or specialist-routing step before consultation.
- A brief note on the bandwidth-optimisation techniques used.

4. Tourism, Travel & Creative Economy

The travel and tourism industry is increasingly becoming more digital, creating opportunities to improve how people discover, plan, experience and respond to changes during their journeys.

PS 4.1 | AI Agent for Travel Disruption Recovery

Context & Challenge: Flight, train and hotel delays or cancellations can leave travellers without a clear way to manage affected bookings and make alternative arrangements. Teams are asked to build an AI agent that detects travel disruptions, identifies affected bookings, evaluates available alternatives and generates a recovery itinerary within predefined traveller constraints.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A working prototype that detects or simulates travel disruptions and identifies affected bookings.
- An AI-driven alternative search and decision flow based on predefined constraints such as budget, timing or destination.
- A recovery itinerary showing the proposed changes and actions required by the traveller.

PS 4.2 | Digital Market Access for Local Artisans

Context & Challenge: Artisans producing Kasuti embroidery, Beedu craft and other coastal crafts have little digital presence or direct buyer access. Teams are asked to build a simple platform giving artisans a way to showcase, price and sell their work to a wider audience.

Suggested hackathon deliverables:

- A solution with working storefront/catalogue interface artisans could plausibly use with minimal training.
- A simple listing-and-order flow (payment integration can be mocked).
- A short craft-storytelling or provenance feature to support pricing.

Judging Criteria (Round One)

1. Innovation & Originality

- How different and creative is the idea compared to what already exists?
- Does the project bring in new features or a fresh approach beyond just solving the given problem?

2. Technical Feasibility

- Is the solution practical and possible to build in real life?
- Have the right technologies been chosen and used appropriately?

3. Impact & Inclusivity

- Does the solution tackle an important problem with a clear social or economic benefit?
- Is it accessible and useful for different kinds of people?

4. Clarity of Submission

- How clearly is the project explained in the PPT?
- Is the flow easy to understand and well structured?

5. Bonus: Business / Monetization Strategy

- Is there a realistic plan to sustain the project in the long term?
- Does the idea have potential to grow and scale?

Rules & Policies

General Rules

- The person who creates the team will automatically be considered the Team Leader.
- All solutions must be original. No plagiarism or old project reuse.
- Teams may not collaborate with other competing teams.
- Projects must align with the chosen problem statement.
- Participants may use standard development tools, libraries and open-source resources.
- Judges' decisions are final and binding.
- Teams must follow all instructions and submission deadlines issued by the organizing team.
- Participation certificates for the offline round will be only issued to the teammates attending the offline hackthon.

On-Campus Stay & Facilities

- Participants must stay on campus throughout the event.
- Accommodation, meals, Wi-Fi and essential amenities will be provided.
- Basic facilities will be made available for participants during the hackathon.
- Participants may bring any personal items they require during their stay.

Code of Conduct

- Maintain professionalism and respect towards fellow participants, mentors, judges and organizers.
- Follow ethical coding practices and avoid any form of misconduct.
- Do not disrupt or interfere with another team's work.
- Cooperate with the organizing team and follow all event rules and schedules.

By participating in DevHack 2026, teams agree to abide by these guidelines and contribute to a fair, collaborative and competitive hackathon experience.

Logistics & Facilities

Venue: Sahyadri Campus, Mangaluru, Karnataka

Bring With You:

- Laptop + charger + extension cord
- Govt. ID + College ID
- Personal essentials

Provided by Organizers:

- Wi-Fi, power outlets and technical support
- Food & snacks at fixed timings
- Sleeping/rest zones on campus

Contact Information

For queries, reach out to:

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